

STRATUM

PLAYER'S GUIDE

Materials, harvesting, crafting, combat and level progression — everything you need for your first sessions in the world.

A persistent shared world. What you build, you keep — the land never resets. Resource nodes and monsters reset on timers, so harvesting never runs out for long.

Controls

Movement and actions use one context-sensitive action key, so there is very little to memorize.

Input	Action
WASD / Arrow keys	Walk
Left mouse button	Context action — strike a beast, else harvest a node, else build
Right mouse button	Release a tile: give claimed land back to the commons
1 – 0	Choose a build material directly
Mouse wheel	Cycle the selected build material
M	Open the world map
T	Open the travel panel (switch maps)
+ / -	Zoom in / out

On a phone, a virtual joystick appears bottom-left (a partial push walks slowly), tapping the world triggers the context action, holding the world for about half a second releases a tile, and the map / travel / zoom controls sit as buttons on the right edge.

Where to Find Materials

Four raw resources are harvested from **volatile nodes** — generated by the world itself, not placed by players, so they can reset on a timer without costing anyone their work. A node only exists on the terrain type it belongs to:

Node	Yields	Found on	Amount	Hits to deplete	Respawn
Tree (trunk)	Wood	Leaf-covered ground (forest)	2 / harvest	3 hits	~45s
Ore seam (vein)	Ore	Ore-bearing rock, both surface and high rock	20 / harvest	4 hits	~90s
Herb (sprig)	Herb	Grass and dark grass	1 / harvest	1 hit	~30s
Crystal (shard)	Crystal	High rock and snow only — never plains or sea	1 / harvest	2 hits	~150s

- Crystal is the rarest and slowest resource everywhere — budget for it separately when planning tools, weapons or armour.
- A node's exact location is fixed the moment the world is generated: the same tile always has (or never has) a node. Nothing here is random per-visit.

Which map has the most of what

Every map is 1024×1024 tiles with its own resource density. The numbers below are the chance a given terrain tile spawns a node — higher is more common.

Map	Character	Node odds (per eligible tile)
0 — THE FIRST ACRES	Verdant, open, where everyone starts	Tree 0.25 ċ Ore 0.30 ċ Herb 0.10 ċ Crystal 0.00
1 — ASHEN HOLLOW	Broken rock, shallow soil, almost nothing grows	Trees 0.35 ċ Ore 0.07 ċ Herb 0.015 ċ Crystal 0.00
2 — THE SUNKEN SHELF	Shallow and shallows, land is scarce and contested	Trees 0.05 ċ Ore 0.35 ċ Herb 0.20 ċ Crystal 0.00

- ASHEN HOLLOW has the best tree odds of all three maps despite the flavor text — "almost nothing grows" refers to build-friendly open ground, not timber.
- THE SUNKEN SHELF is the best single map for ore, herb AND crystal at once — the tradeoff is that land itself is scarce there, so claiming a base is harder.
- Land does not carry over between maps: claiming a tile on map 0 has no effect on the same coordinates on map 1 or 2. Use T to travel between them.

How Harvesting Works

Left-click a node within your reach (6 tiles) to strike it. Most nodes take more than one hit to break open — the node's own HP is shown as hits in the table above. Each hit before the final one gives nothing; the final hit yields the full amount and immediately starts the respawn timer, so nothing is ever double-harvested.

A depleted node is visibly different in the world and cannot be harvested again until its timer runs out and it regrows — the client shows the remaining wait if you try.

Tools change how much you get

Better tools raise your harvest amount per node and let it happen faster. Each tier unlocks at the previous tier's tool station and is bought outright with resources:

Tier	Name	Yield mult.	Speed mult.	Unlock cost	Requires
0	Flint	×1.00	×1.00	wood 2	— (starting tier)
1	Copper	×1.25	×1.15	wood 3, ore 2	flint
2	Iron	×1.50	×1.35	wood 2, ore 5	copper
3	Steel	×2.00	×1.60	ore 8, crystal 3	iron

■ A tool's yield bonus never makes you worse off — the game always grants the higher of your tool bonus or the base amount.

■ Ore is the hardest resource to work (harder than wood or herb), so the tool bonus on ore is reduced a little compared to softer nodes — crystal is hardest of all. Upgrading tools still always pays off, just not identically on every resource.

Building & Claiming Land

Placing a tile does two things at once: it spends 1 point of **will** (energy, regenerates on its own over time) and it consumes harvested resources. The tile becomes permanently yours — nobody else can alter or overwrite it, ever, unless you release it (right-click, or hold on mobile) which returns it to the shared commons for free.

Material	Resource cost
Dirt	wood 1
Grass	herb 1
Stone	wood 1, ore 1
Sand	wood 1
Water	wood 2
Wood platform	wood 3
Brick	wood 2, ore 2
Glass	wood 2, ore 1
Path	wood 1, ore 1
Lamp	wood 1, ore 1, crystal 1

- You must be within 6 tiles of a spot to build or harvest there — the server checks this itself, so there is no way to build at range.
- Releasing a tile is always free (0 will, no resources) — there is no penalty for changing your mind about unclaimed-looking land you no longer want.

Crafting Gear

Weapons and armour are crafted from the same four raw resources at a craft station, gated by your current tool tier. A weapon's **damage bonus** adds straight to your attack; armour's **mitigation** is subtracted from every hit you take (a hit always costs at least 1 HP no matter how much armour you wear). You can carry many recipes but only your single best weapon and best armour count toward combat.

Tool tier needed	Item	Slot	Effect	Cost
Tier 0	Flint dagger	weapon	+3 dmg	wood 2, ore 1
Tier 0	Hide vest	armour	−2 dmg taken	wood 2, herb 2
Tier 1	Copper sword	weapon	+7 dmg	wood 3, ore 3
Tier 1	Copper plate	armour	−5 dmg taken	ore 4, herb 2
Tier 2	Iron axe	weapon	+12 dmg	wood 4, ore 5, herb 2
Tier 2	Iron mail	armour	−9 dmg taken	wood 3, ore 6
Tier 3	Steel blade	weapon	+18 dmg	wood 4, ore 7, crystal 3
Tier 3	Steel aegis	armour	−14 dmg taken	ore 8, herb 3, crystal 4

■ A recipe is locked until your tool tier reaches its own — you cannot craft the copper sword on flint tools, even if you can afford the materials.

Combat & Level Progression

Left-click a creature within 3 tiles to attack it. Your own attack has a short recovery window (a quarter-second) so blows cannot be spammed. Watch a monster's wind-up — most attacks are telegraphed, and stepping out of range during the wind-up dodges the hit entirely.

Killing a monster grants XP to you and only you, plus a roll on that species' loot table (added straight to your inventory). Your level is **derived from lifetime XP** and is never stored directly; your max HP and base attack are in turn derived from your level, so they update automatically the moment you level up.

Level	Max HP	Base attack	Notes
1	100	7	—
5	160	9	~30 $\times$; growth of prior levels
10	235	11	grows ~1.6 $\times$; faster each level
20	385	16	steep past here
40 (max)	685	26	level cap

XP to reach the next level starts at 30 and multiplies by 1.6 $\times$ per level, so early levels are quick and the climb toward 40 is a long haul. Your effective attack in a fight also adds any weapon's damage bonus on top of your level's base attack, and armour subtracts its mitigation from incoming damage.

- A creature that goes untouched for about 12 seconds slowly heals itself back up — don't start a fight you can't finish in one push.
- Pack hunters (the hound-type monsters) call nearby allies of their own species the moment they notice you — expect reinforcements, not a single fight.
- Every creature has a leash: drag it far enough from its home and it gives up and walks back, healing as it goes. Kiting a monster away from its group is a valid tactic.

The Three Maps at a Glance

#	Name	Tone	Character
0	THE FIRST ACRE	Gentle	Verdant and open — where everyone starts and builds first.
1	ASHEN HOLLOW	Hostile	Broken rock, heavy ore, fire-touched monsters. Bring your own timber.
2	THE SUNKEN SHELF	Amphibious	Islands and shallows. Land is scarce here, and contested.

Press **T** to travel between maps at any time from a safe location. Your position, inventory, tools, HP and kills all persist — only your claimed land stays behind, map by map.

This guide reflects the current build's shipped numbers (terrain generation, resource yields, tool tiers, recipes and the level curve). Balance may change in future updates.